



FROST DATES & SEASON

Last frost: March 5 – March 25
First frost: November 1 – November 25
Season: 225–265 days

THIS MONTH — MAY 2026

1. All warm-season crops are established or in the ground — last frost passed in March. April is full growing season in Zone 8.
2. Plant sweet potato slips now (soil above 65°F). Plant okra and southern peas for summer harvest.
3. Harvest spring crops (lettuce, broccoli, peas) before they bolt. Succession sow beans and corn for summer.

QUICK-START CROPS

Homestead tomato (OP)
80 days, heat-tolerant, disease-resistant, bred for the South. Reliable where heirlooms struggle.

Clemson Spineless okra (H)
Zone staple. Direct sow March–April, harvest June–November. Thrives in Zone 8 heat.

Seminole pumpkin (H)
Heat-and-humidity-tolerant heirloom. Resists vine borers, stores one year without refrigeration.

STORAGE & PRESERVATION

- Summer ferments are reliable in Zone 8 — active cultures out-compete spoilage. Kimchi and dilly beans work well.
- Sweet potato curing and long storage is highest-ROI: one 4×8 ft bed yields 50–80 lbs, stores 8–12 months cured.
- Dehydration shines here: hot peppers, okra & tomatoes reduce to compact shelf-stable storage.

ZONE
8

Deep South, Coastal Pacific
Northwest, Central Texas
Portland OR · Dallas TX · Atlanta GA

HEIRLOOM VARIETY SPOTLIGHT

Homestead tomato (OP)
Bred for Southern conditions. 80 days, disease-resistant. Reliably productive where Brandywine fails in July humidity.

Seminole pumpkin (H)
The historically grown squash of the Southeast. Pest-resistant, 12-month storage, sprawling vine.

Rattlesnake watermelon (H)
90 days, 25–40 lbs, thrives in Zone 8 heat and humidity. A Southern heirloom worth growing.